

Cyclepaths

Game Design Document

Version 1.00

JMC Academy
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Vision

Cyclepaths is a split-screen combat racing arena party game. In which players will choose their vehicle and compete against other players locally.

Aimed for a release on consoles and PCs it will be designed to use a gaming controller, which most people feel comfortable using for driving based games.

The thing that set Cyclepaths apart from others in its' genre is that instead of on focusing on what is in front of you (as you do in most combat racing arena games) you are trailing a destructive wall of energy behind your vehicle, which you will need to use in order to kill your co-players (friends, family, etc.); while trying to avoid the challenges of the environment.

The main emotion that are intended to be felt while playing are excitement, enjoyment, and fast paced tension caused by the split screen multiplayer component.

The art style will be Semi-stylized (Stylized but with less cartoonish elements, but not quite trying for photo-realism), and the mood for the world is intended to be one of a post-apocalyptic nature where some technology has been kept safe and pristine, while other elements of the world are crude and cobbled together.

The core audience for our game would be those in the age groups of 13 to mid 30s, however that is not to say that those outside of the intended demographic would not enjoy it. Due to its' party game style it would have a similar player base to MarioKart but would be less likely to catch on with younger players because of its' more mature art style similar to Crossout.

Table of contents

Vision	2
Table of contents	3
Moment-to-moment gameplay	4
Gameplay modes	4
Avatar actions and abilities	4
Pick-Ups	4
Vehicles	5
Main HUD and control scheme	9
Enemies and obstacles	11
Interactive environmental elements	11
Multiplayer	12
Game shell	13
Information and options	15
Tutorial and help system	16
Typical player experience sequence	17
(Arena 1 Colosseum)	18
Gameplay overview	18
Mood and visual style	18
(Arena 2 Hanging Chains)	19
Gameplay overview	19
Mood and visual style	19
(Arena 3)	20
Gameplay overview	20
Mood and visual style	20
(Arena 4)	22
Gameplay overview	22
Mood and visual style	22
(Arena 5)	24
Gameplay overview	24
Mood and visual style	24
(Arena 6)	26
Gameplay overview	26
Mood and visual style	26
(Arena 7)	27
Gameplay overview	27
Mood and visual style	27

Moment-to-moment gameplay

GAMEPLAY MODES

The only intended game style that is intended at this point is a Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

AVATAR ACTIONS AND ABILITIES

- Vehicles - There are a number of vehicles for the player/s to choose from when starting the game, with different ones giving different dis/advantages.

PICK-UPS

Pick-up 1

Speed boost - Useable at will to grant the user a temporary speed boost, can either be used offensively or defensively. For example if an enemy is closing in on you, one could use the boost to get away, or to cut them off destroying the other driver, it's all down to how you want to play.

Pick-up 2

Phase shift - The Phase shift pickup can be used at will, when used the user can drive through his own or other drivers light trails and even minor obstacles for a short amount of time. The phase shift will be very useful for getting out of sticky situations, or even setting up traps for other drivers simpler without running the risk of driving into your own or other players walls.

Pick-up 3

Light wall- The light wall is a one time use pickup which allows the player to deploy a wall of light at will which does not affect the user.



Images of power-

VEHICLES

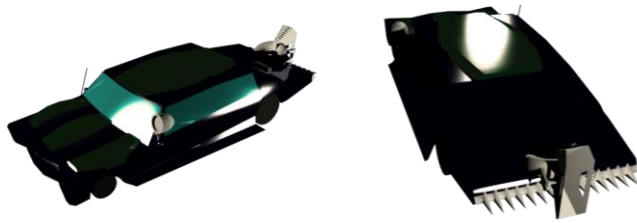
Vehicle 1

The Battle-Lobster - A large motorcycle that looks like a cross between a penny farthing bicycle and a combine harvester.



Vehicle 2

The Impaler - A 1960's-ish muscle car that has been modified for battle, including heavy armour plating, and spikes.



Vehicle 3

The Stinger - A street racing car from the 2010's that has been upgraded to be fast, nimble, and a force to be reckoned with.



2012 camaro zl1

Vehicle 4

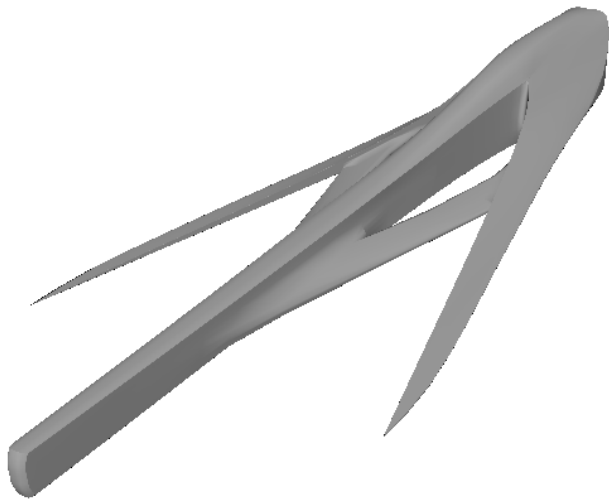
The Fortress that drives - This vehicle is not so much a car, a more apt description would be an off road rally light tank.



The Tumbler (Batman: The

Vehicle 5

The Prototype - Sleek and stylin' this “bike” is one of the earliest vehicles to have light-trail technology, and as such is worth a small fortune.



MAIN HUD AND CONTROL SCHEME

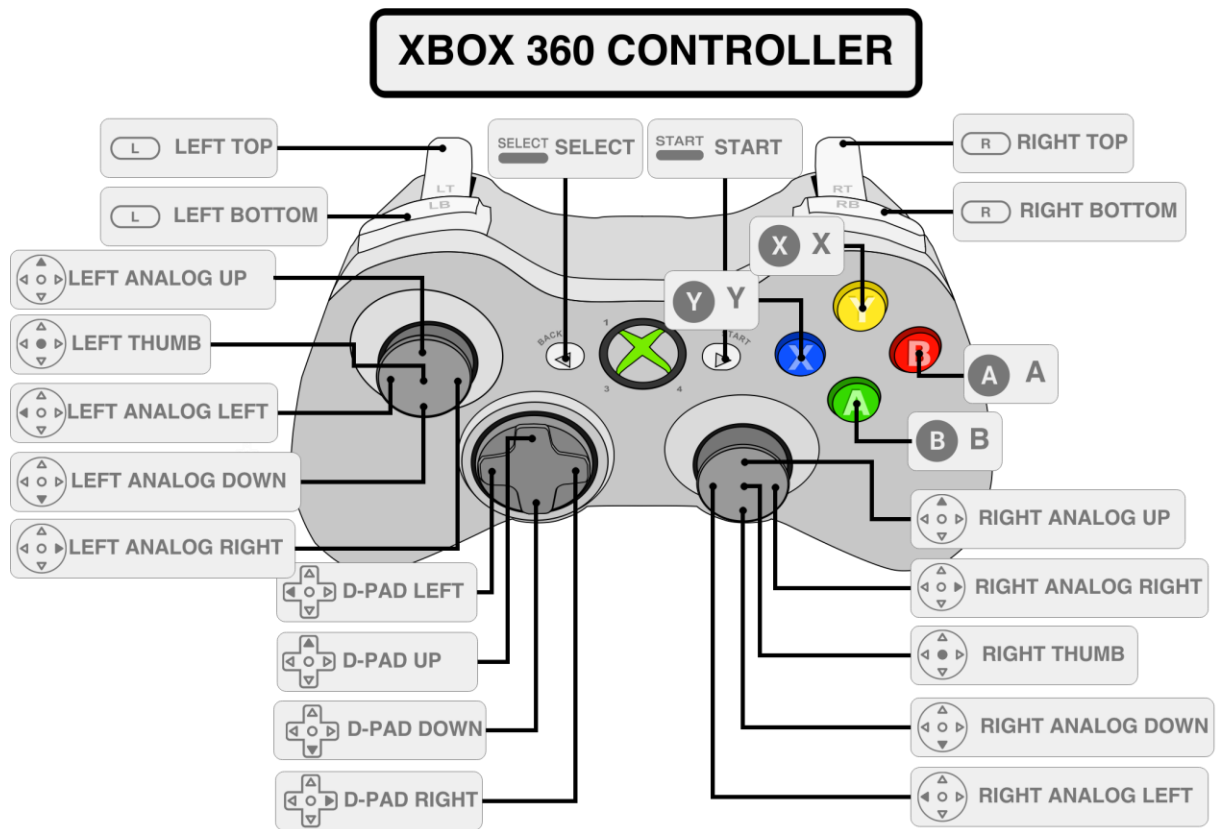
For the most part there will be little to no constant HUD during the gameplay sections of the game, the only exception to this would be a life counter, and a top down minimap, to allow the players to locate one another, pick-ups and environmental obstacles.

Additionally there will be an icon that displays when a player acquires a pick-up.

Control Schemes;

Xbox-360 controller / Computer

Left Trigger	Hold to reverse
Left Bumper	
Right Trigger	Hold to Accelerate
Right Bumper	
Left Analog Press	
Left Analog Rotate	Steers the Vehicle Navigate Menu (Player 1 only)
Right Analog Press	
Right Analog Rotate	Changes camera angle
D-pad left	
D-pad right	
D-pad up	
D-pad down	
X	Kill Self (Hold Button)
A	Activates the power-up/Select Menu options
B	
Y	Taunt
Start	Pause/Menu
Back	Show Scoreboard



Xbox 360 Gamepad; Microsoft

ENEMIES AND OBSTACLES

The enemies in the game is the other players, friends, family etc.

Obstacles include the other players light trail, their power-ups; and the environment in the form of ramps, walls and other various traps .

INTERACTIVE ENVIRONMENTAL ELEMENTS

Environment hazards will be included to add another dynamic to the gameplay experience.

These hazards will include rotating blades, pits, spikes, and lasers.

The environment won't just have hazardous obstacles, it will also include parts of the environment that can be used by the player such as power-ups, jumps, tunnels, elevated viewpoints etc.

MULTIPLAYER

The Multiplayer elements are the sole gameplay mode and designed for 2 - 4 players in split screen, for a couch styled party gaming experience.

The camera will either split horizontally for 2 players, for 3 players it will split the 2nd and 3rd players across the bottom section, and the game would divide the screen into quadrants for 4 players.



Split Screen



Plus Screen



More Screen

Game shell

Main Menu

Start new game -

From here you pick the number of players and initiate the game.

Options -

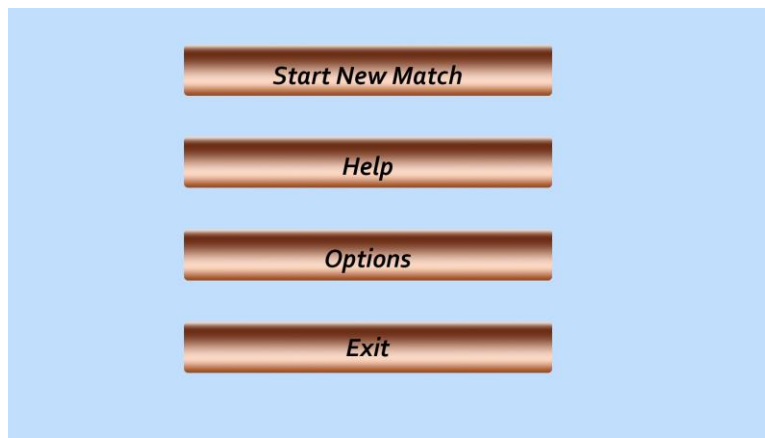
Here you would choose options that affect the way the game displays; sound on/off, screen ratio, etc.

Help -

This section will contain information on how to play the game.

Exit -

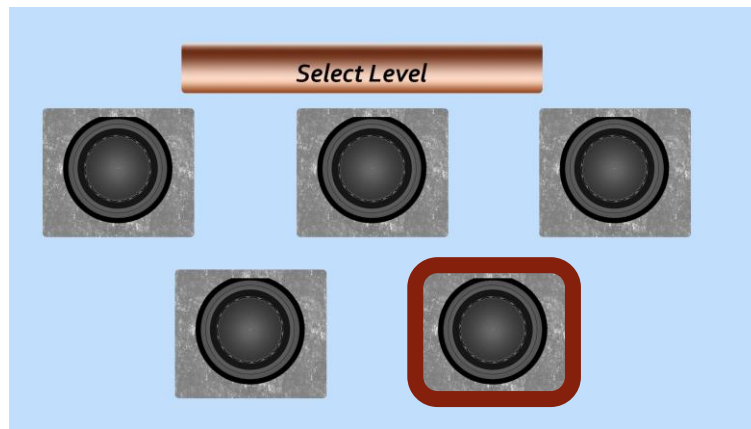
Close the game exiting to the home screen.



Level Selection Menu

Level Select -

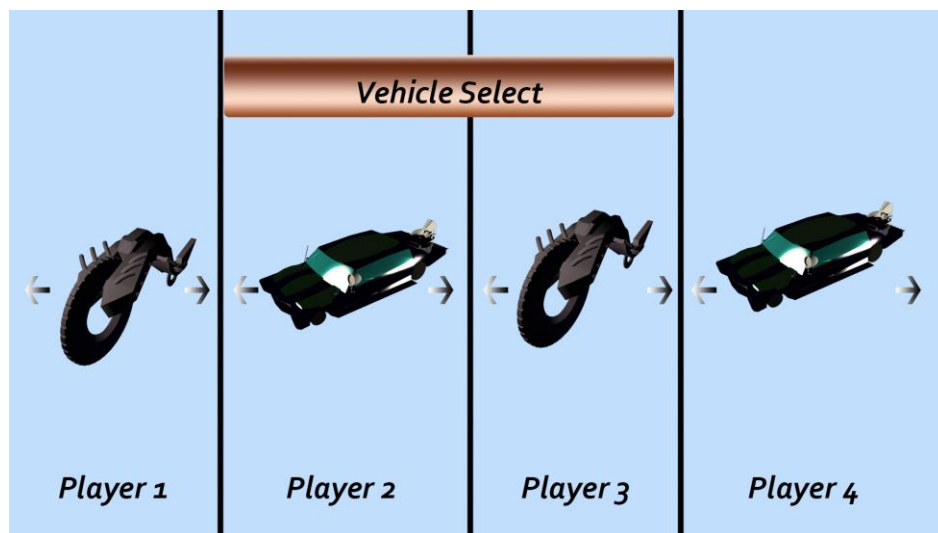
This would give the options for the different levels.



Vehicle Selection Menu

Vehicle/character Select -

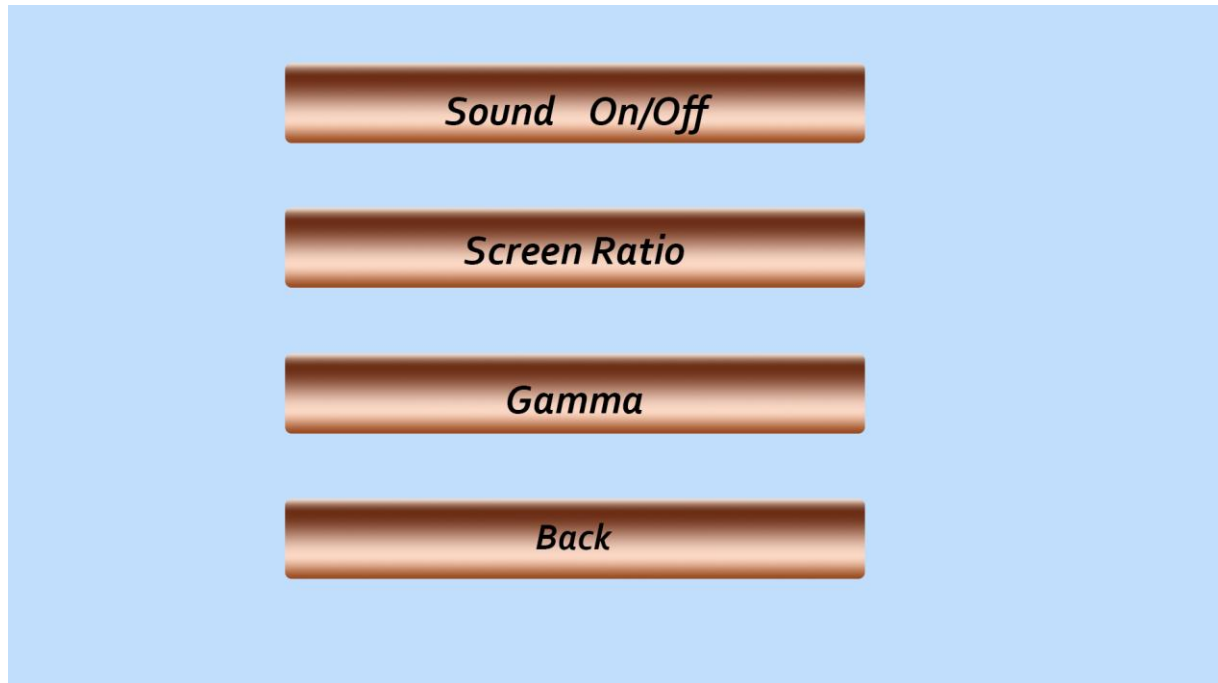
Here is where the player/s would select the vehicle that they want to use in the game an which colour they wish to play as.



Information and options

The pause menu will have resume button to get back into the game play and a main menu button to return to the main menu. An options button will also be here to change settings as needed by the players.

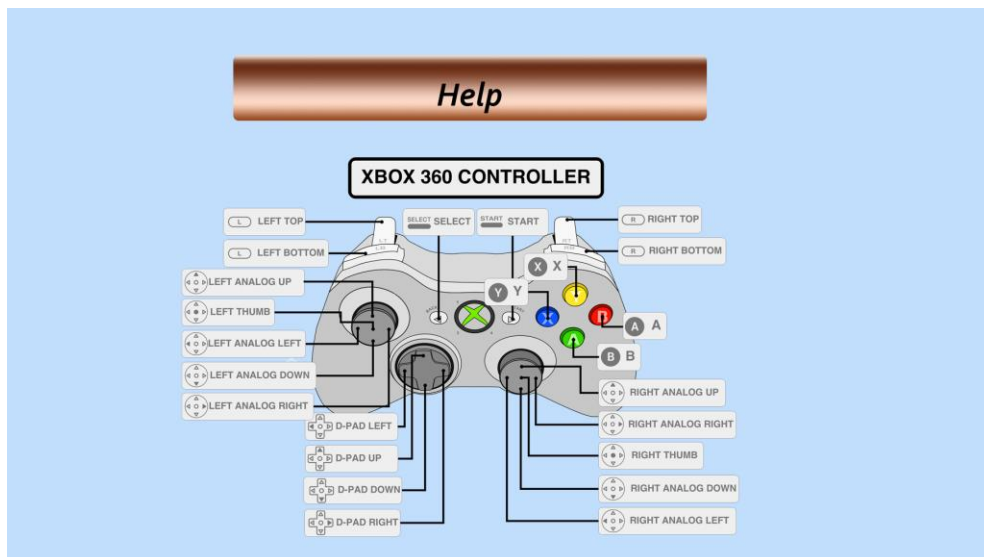
In the options menu there will be an options to adjust the screen's resolution, audio levels.



Tutorial and help system

For the tutorial section of the game there will be a help section in the menu which will show the player how to play, which buttons do what, what the different power-ups look like and do, and the best way to use them.

And if the game requires a loading screen one of the tutorial pages will display as a pop up during it.



Typical player experience sequence

First the players select the game map, the number of players, their vehicle/s and colour.

Next the loading tutorial screen comes across the screen.

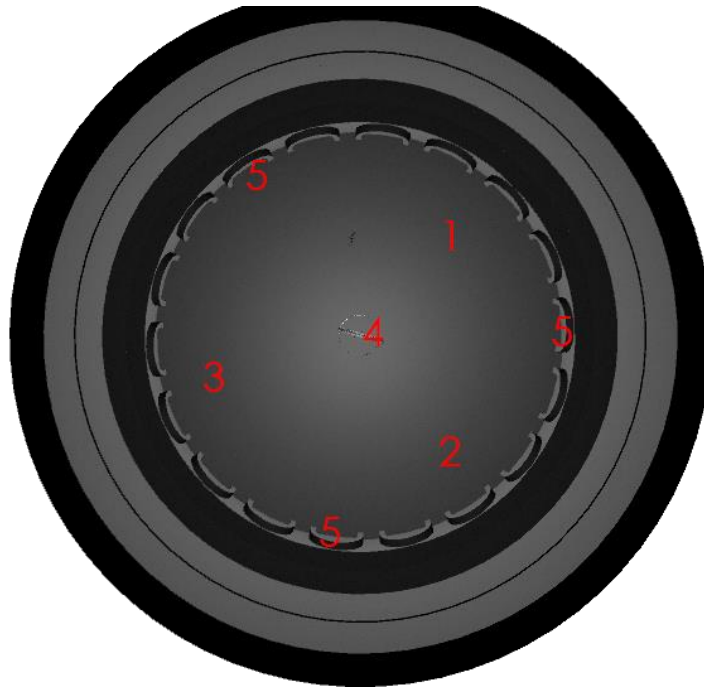
Once loaded the countdown goes from 3 to 1 as the players vehicles appear on the screen, once the countdown hits 0 the players gain control over their vehicles.

The players then try to drive ahead of one another and destroy each other using their light-trails.

As the players die their life counter goes from 3 to 0, and once at 0 the next death takes them out of the match.

When there is only one player still alive they are presented with the win state.

(ARENA 1 COLOSSEUM)



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

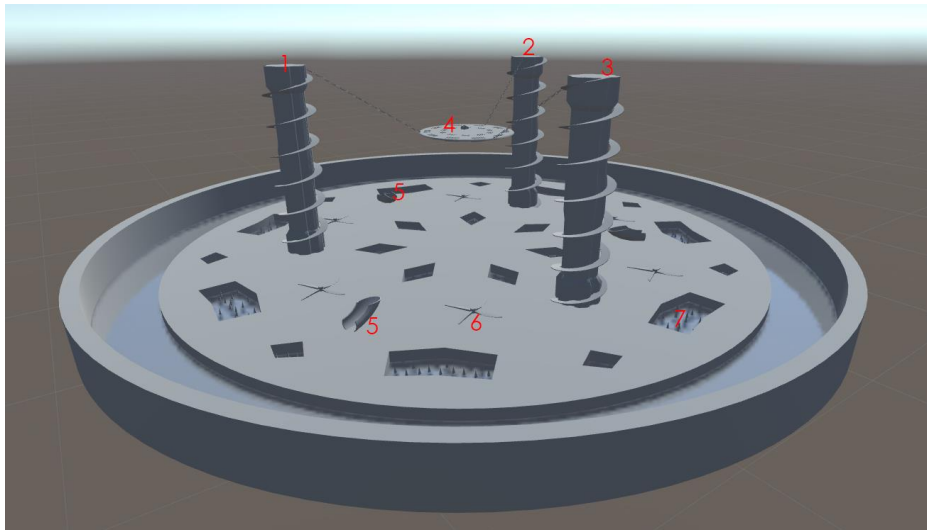
Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This is a very simple arena, styled to look like an Ancient Roman Colosseum. It is designed to be simple to start and then after a set time an additional challenge is added when a gun/laser turret becomes active in the center.

Key	Feature	Notes
1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
4	Laser Turret	A laser turret that pops up after a set amount of time and then fires into the arena adding an additional challenge
5	Re/spawn Point	The location/s where the Players re/spawn

(ARENA 2 HANGING CHAINS)



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

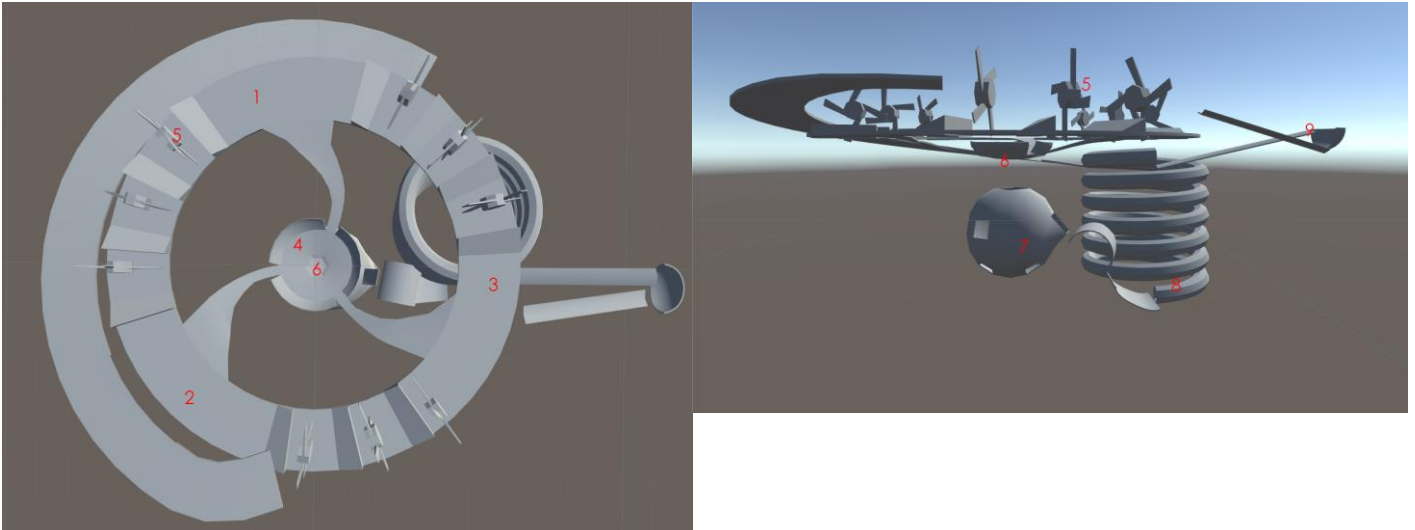
Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This arena has been designed to look similar to the last in that it is a colosseum, but this one is a lot more dangerous, including rotating blades, spike pits and a moat.

KEY	FEATURE	NOTES
1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
4	Re/spawn Point	The location/s where the Players re/spawn
5	JUMPERS	BOOSTS THAT WILL MOVE THE PLAYER FROM THE BOTTOM AREA TO THE HANGING PLATFORM
6	ROTATING BLADES	ROTATING BLADES THAT WILL KILL THE PLAYERS ON CONTACT
7	SPIKE PITS	SPIKE PITS THAT WILL KILL PLAYERS THAT FALL INTO THEM

(ARENA 3) - BURNING RUBBER



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

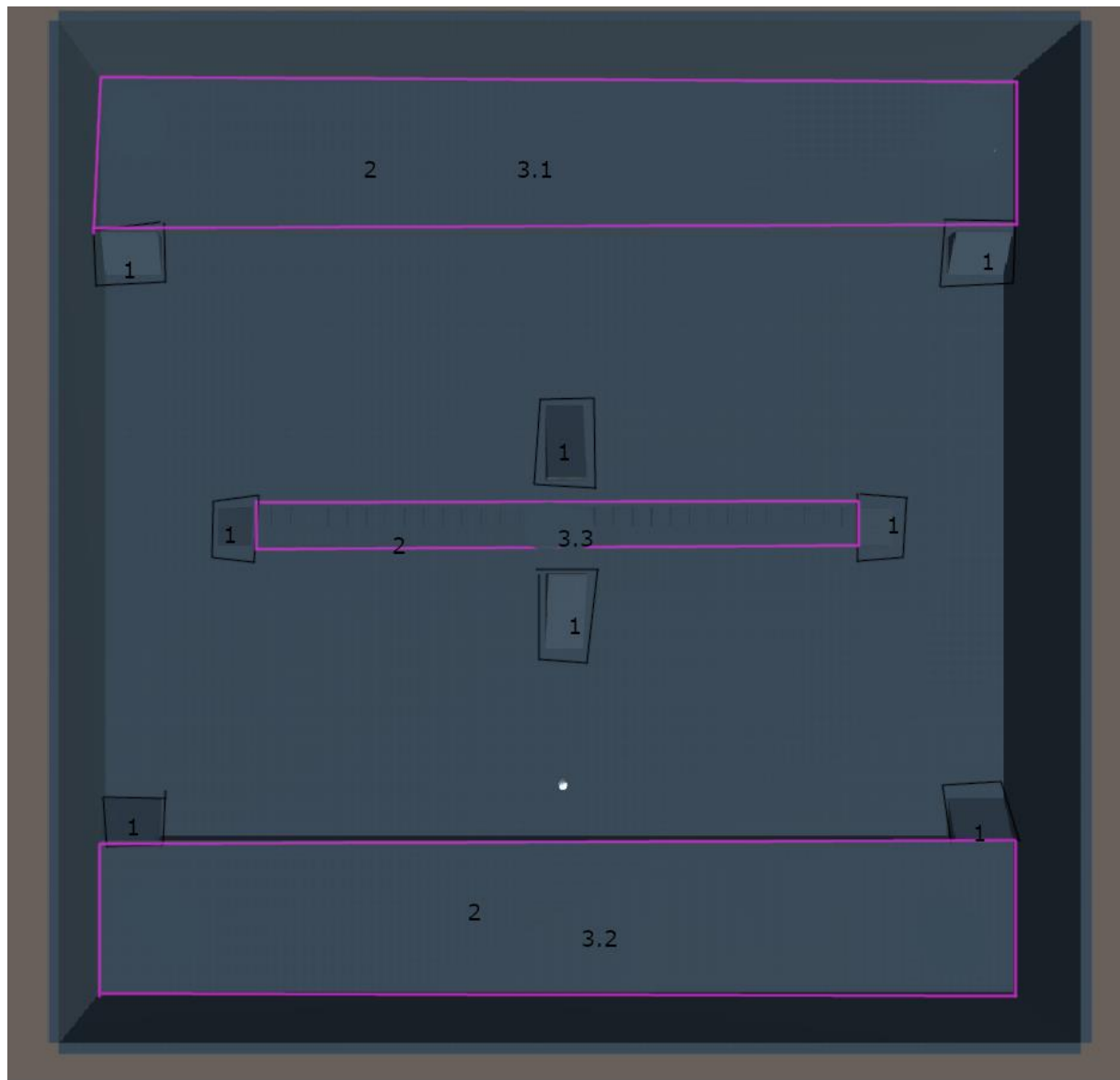
Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This arena is designed to be hectic and fast paced, featuring falls into pits, spiralling tunnels, rotating blades, and jumps. The visual style is designed to give the player a similar feel to a Hot Wheels track.

Key	Feature	Notes
1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
4	Re/spawn Point	The location/s where the Players re/spawn
5	Rotating Blades	Rotating blades that will kill the player on contact
6	Hole	A hole that if the player falls into will leave them in the pit
7	Pit	A pit like chamber that the player will need to find the correct exit for in order to use the Spiral and Jump to return to the main area
8	Spiral	A large spiralled tunnel that will let the player move back up to the main area
9	Jump	A U-turn jump that the player will need to make in order to get back into the main area

(ARENA 4) - RAMP-AGE



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

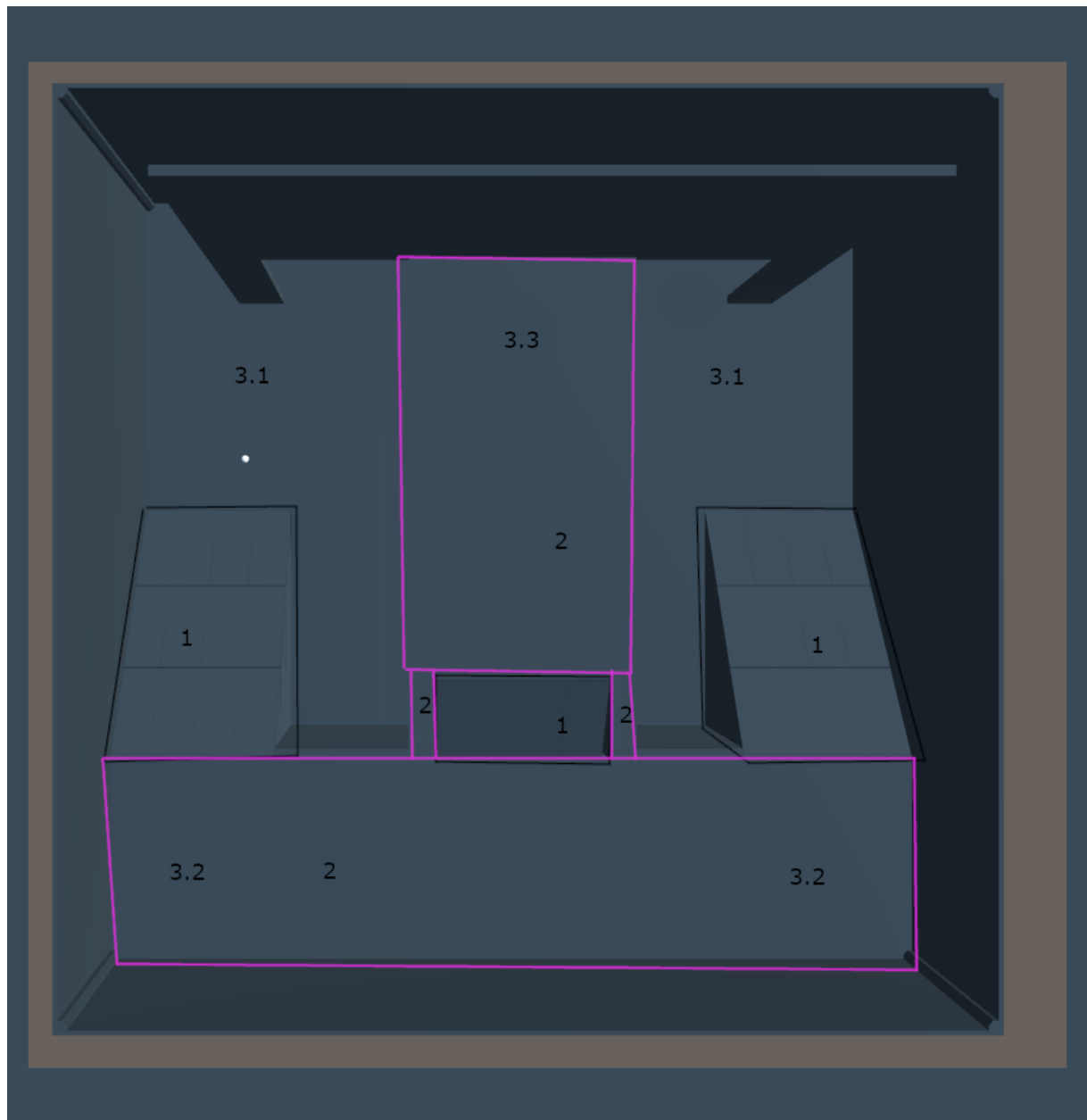
MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This level is intended to be simple and easy to play on , a beginners level of sorts.

Key	Feature	Notes
3.1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
3.2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3.3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point

1	Ramp	Used to get up to a higher area
2	Higher areas	A spot above a the lowest point in the level

(ARENA 5) - PLANKS!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

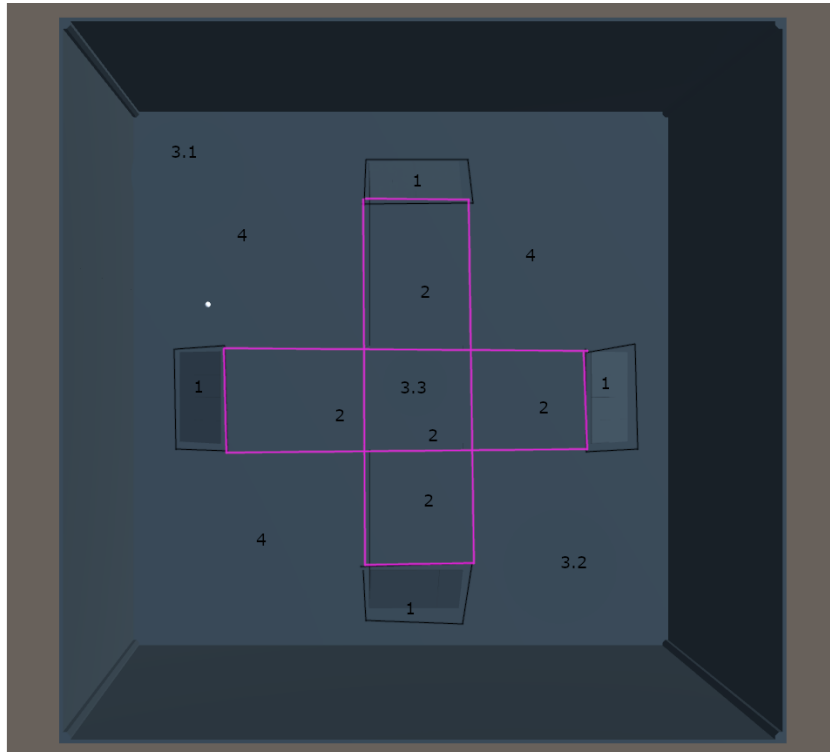
MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This level is larger in height with the emphasis in being above your enemy to have the advantage, plenty of walls so be on your guard and look before you leap.

Key	Feature	Notes
3.1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point

3.2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3.3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
1	Ramp	Used to get up to a higher area
2	Higher areas	A spot above a the lowest point in the level

(ARENA 6) - FIRST - AID



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

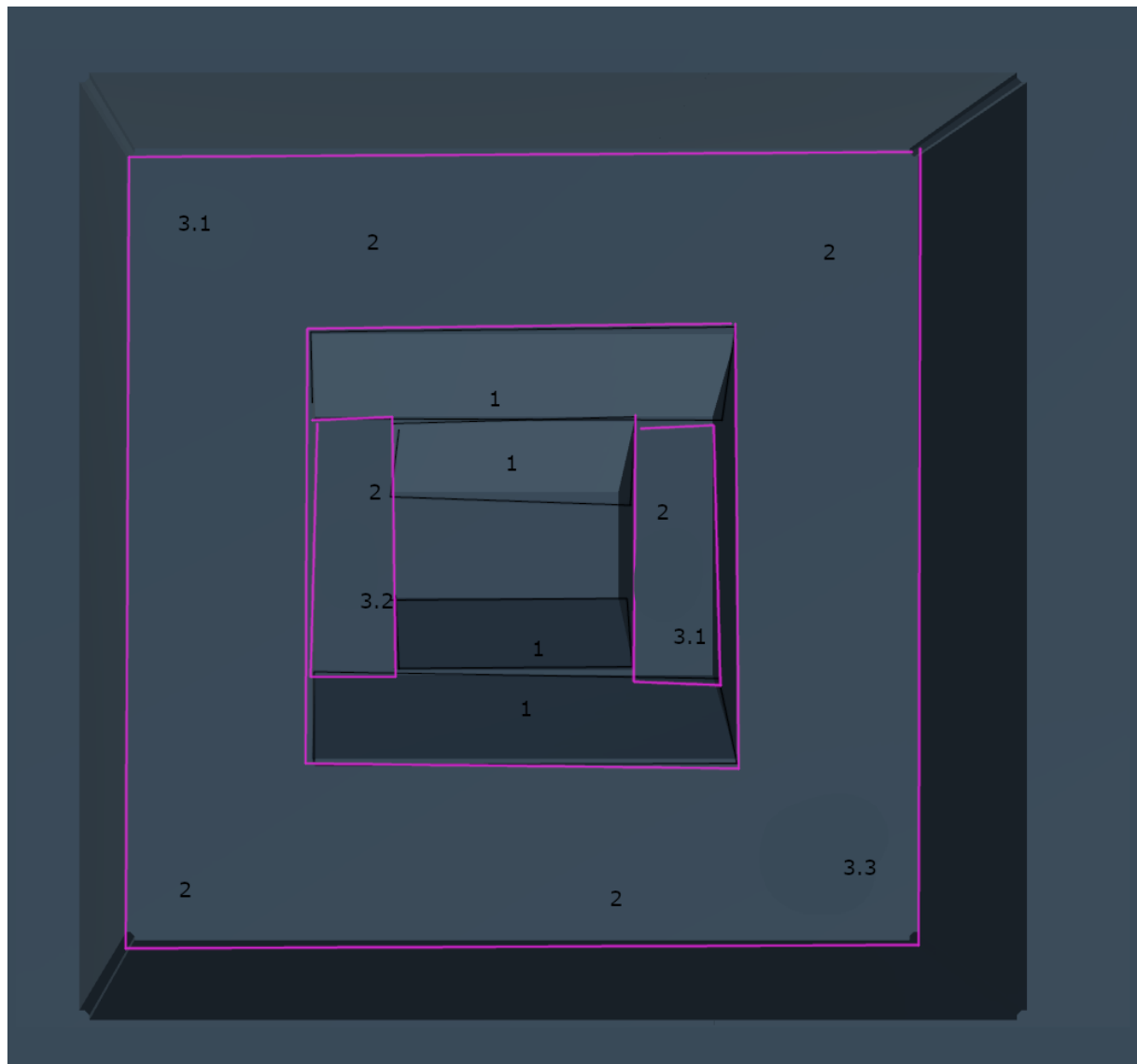
Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This level is intended to be one of possibilities where you can either play on the inner platform or outer ring or a bit of both to out maneuver your opponent.

Key	Feature	Notes
3.1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
3.2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point
3.3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
1	Ramp	Used to get up to a higher area
2	Higher areas	A spot above a the lowest point in the level

(ARENA 7)



GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

Multiplayer battle arena mode. In this mode the players will compete to destroy one another in an environment using their light trails, with last player standing winning.

MOOD AND VISUAL STYLE

This level is set in multiple layers you can maneuver around the level as you will the middle of the map is easily the most dangerous part as it is difficult to see into, this fact adds a new layer of difficulty one not added by the environment but the uncertainty, is someone down there? Do i risk it?

Key	Feature	Notes
3.1	Pick-Up 1	Speed boost pick-up spawn point
3.2	Pick-Up 2	Phase Shift pick-up spawn point

3.3	Pick-Up 3	Light Wall pick-up spawn point
1	Ramp	Used to get up to a higher area
2	Higher areas	A spot above a the lowest point in the level

